Lane Middle School

Request for School Name Change

PORTLAND Public Schools

June 9, 2026

Renaming Committee Work

- The Lane Middle School Renaming Committee was established in the spring of 2023.
- The committee was made up of staff, students, alumni, community partners, and parents.
- The process started in 2022 and continued through building leadership changes as well as district leadership changes, with the goal of finding a name that aligns with the mission and vision of our school.
- The initial survey in 2023 and a second survey sent in February of 2026 yielded ideas that ranged from names of people to symbolic names related to our region. We eliminated names connected to individuals, as well as names of schools in the Portland-Metro Area. This left us with 5 candidates.
- The voting process was held in May 2026, and 415 votes were cast from a community of current students, alumni, family members, neighbors, and staff.

Reclaiming Our Name: From Lane to Brentwood

When our school opened in 1922, it was named *Errol Heights School*—firmly rooted in **local geography**, just like a dozen other schools across Southeast Portland. Its 1926 renaming to honor Joseph Lane tethered the building to a history of anti-indigenous child hostage-taking and radical pro-slavery advocacy that directly violates the safety and equity values of PPS today.

As community values evolved, residents took action. By the 1980s and 1990s, the neighborhood formalized a modern, inclusive identity by officially adopting the name Brentwood-Darlington. Transitioning to **Brentwood Middle School** returns the building to its original purpose. Derived from the Old English for "burnt wood" (a forest clearing), Brentwood is a purely geographic name that honors no single individual. Adopting it permanently insulates the district from biographical controversies, celebrates a resilient community once named Portland's "Neighborhood of the Year," and directly fulfills City of Portland policies to reinforce local neighborhood identity through our public schools.

Voting Results: School Name

Name	Students/Staff Ballot	Alumni/Community Ballot	Total
Brentwood	144	63	207
Brentwood - Darlington	25	14	39
Darlington	15	16	31
Oregon Pines	43	17	60
Hemlock	28	14	42

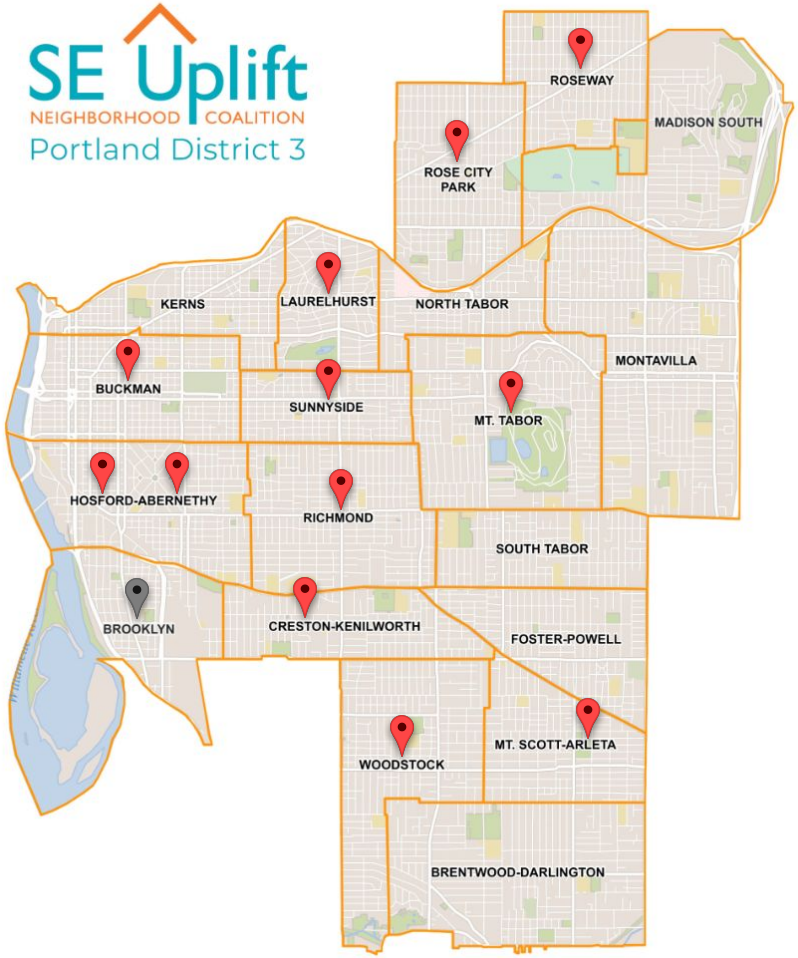
Voting Results: Mascot

Mascot	Students/Staff Ballot
Bears	78
Bobcats	77
Ravens	77
Otters	40

Of the 415 votes cast, Bears, Bobcats, Ravens, and Otters were the leading mascots from the 14 original options*. We wanted to see how our current students and staff would vote between the four most popular, and **BEARS** was the leading choice in both ballots.

**Bears, Bobcats, Beavers, Tigers, Buffaloes, Ravens, Badgers, Panthers, Eagles, Otters, Jaguars, Wolves, Hawks, and Raptors.*


Thank you!



Portland's District 3

Looking at the neighborhoods that make up District 3 in Southeast Portland, one might mistake this map of **neighborhoods** for a map of ***Portland schools***.

At least *a dozen PPS schools*, in our district alone, share a name with their neighborhood.

When we become **Brentwood Middle School**, we follow in the footsteps of many of our closest neighbors.